

Statement of purpose

The fact that there is so much more to see than what meets the human naked eye has always resonated with me since childhood. The realization that hidden insights within data can influence global leadership and even decide the outcomes of wars has always kept me on the edge of my seat. I was born in a period when Information Technology was a buzzword in the market, and little did I know that I would one day pursue it as a long-term career. I have always been a curious child, raised by parents who encouraged me to question everything with rationale. This instilled an analytical mindset in me from an early age. As a Data Scientist, I have rigorously worked on a range of projects for 5 years, making me value and appreciate the nexus between Technology and Business. However, in today's rapidly growing data and emerging technologies, I've realized the need to enhance my computing knowledge while deepening my expertise in Data Science. Apart from academics, I was very fond of quizzes and Sports and frequently participated in sports, cultural events, and quiz competitions.

Engineering brings a touch of magic to the world, and my fascination with experiencing and creating this magic through analytics inspired me to pursue a career in engineering, choosing Information Technology as my major from Rajasthan Technical University. The coursework at the undergraduate level was well-designed and covered a range of topics, including Engineering Mathematics, Fundamental of Computer programming, Object Oriented Programming, Advanced Data Structures, Advance Data Base Management Systems, and Data Mining & Ware Housing among others. Even though my curriculum offered limited opportunities in data science, my strong interest in the field drove me to step beyond the coursework and pursue specialized training in "Python(Core + Advance) + Data Science" from GRRAS Solutions Pvt. Ltd. I completed the program, culminating in a data science project on regression, where I developed a model to predict housing prices based on various parameters. To me, learning was always about the practical application of classroom concepts. Building on this principle, I continued enhancing my skills, delving into areas like Natural Language Processing (NLP) for text data processing. As a part of my final graduation project, I applied these concepts to develop a classification model for spam and non-spam email detection. These experiences not only strengthened my technical expertise but also paved the way for me to land a job as a Data Scientist at one of the Fortune 500 tech giants, where I could apply my skills to solve real-world problems.

I joined Cognizant as a Programmer Analyst Trainee right after college, where I honed my skills working in the healthcare vertical on projects such as chatbots, a denial prediction model using ensemble learning algorithms, decision trees, and a prioritization model. This role not only provided me with the platform to regularly sharpen my technical expertise and problem-solving abilities but also gave me invaluable insights into how businesses leverage technology to modernize processes and drive efficiency. Over the course of two years, my dedication and growing understanding of the business led to two well-deserved promotions. The COVID-19 pandemic during my tenure at Cognizant was a transformative experience. It highlighted the immense power of data science not just in driving business decisions but also in addressing critical global challenges. From predicting the pandemic's trajectory to estimating vaccination needs and timelines, data science proved instrumental in shaping responses to the crisis. Witnessing its societal impact reinforced my passion for the field and inspired me to take the next step in my career. I joined the core analytical organization where I am currently employed.

I joined Tiger Analytics as a Senior Data Analyst, where I have worked for three years and grown significantly both technically and professionally. My journey began with hands-on experience in diverse

aspects of analytics, including analysis, modeling, project planning, implementation, and monitoring. My domain of work is the RCPG segment, where I successfully delivered Digital Commerce projects like On-Demand Delivery Assortment for the UAE market and market media mix modeling (MMX) for the European food sector. These projects focused on enabling data-driven decision-making to improve SKU performance, resulting in extensive product segmentation using distribution, velocity, and marketing methods. In another significant project on Trade Promotion Optimization (TPO) for the European pet care market, I led a team of three data scientists over the course of a year. This project focused on identifying important Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) and using them to recommend optimum pricing and promotional values to better incentivize both retailers and manufacturers. I demonstrated advanced statistical techniques such as Bayesian modeling and Hierarchical Linear Modeling (HLM) to improve prediction accuracy with metrics like MAPE and R^2 scores and delivered descriptive dashboards for insights, along with simulation and optimization tools to evaluate impacts through various experiments. The success of this project not only earned me a promotion but also led to its replication across multiple geographies, further amplifying its business impact. As my expertise grew, I ventured into advanced areas of data engineering and big data analytics. I built automated data pipelines and utilized Spark to enable parallel processing for large-scale data analytics. Working on the Azure cloud platform, I developed end-to-end solutions for data orchestration, ingestion, and analysis. These experiences have not only enhanced my technical skills but also helped me develop essential professional qualities like leadership, teamwork, and time management. Given my background in Information Technology, combined with my diverse professional experience across multiple verticals, geographies, and segments, I have gained expertise in a wide range of use cases, along with great technical skills and business knowledge, making me a strong candidate for the master's program. I am eager to leverage this background to excel in the Data Science program and contribute meaningfully to the academic community.

I am applying for the (Program name) program at your esteemed (university name) because it offers a comprehensive curriculum perfectly aligned with my career aspirations and the broad choice of elective courses would allow me to customize my learning experience (Module Name). However, the most appealing feature of this program is (Any individual project, dissertation, co-op, professor, research group, or internship) where I would get the opportunity to implement my classroom learning in real-world scenarios. Also, this program is the opportunity to collaborate with a globally diverse student community. Interacting with peers from different backgrounds will help me exchange knowledge, gain new perspectives, and grow intellectually. This collaborative environment will not only deepen my understanding of data science but also build meaningful connections and create future opportunities. Learning from world-class faculty in such a setting makes the experience even more enriching.

Post the completion of this program, I would get back to my homeland empowered with the caliber to churn out sustainable and strategic solutions for my organization. I aspire to work as a Data Scientist, Business analyst, or Data Analyst in top-notch product-based companies like Samsung R&D, Amazon, Apple, Microsoft, Google, Walmart, LinkedIn, PayPal, etc. Subsequently, I aim to create or to be a part of a Data Science community where individual progress drives collective growth, creating a dynamic, two-way process where everyone thrives together.

I strongly believe that the high standards of education at (University name) provide a conducive environment for me to learn and work toward achieving my goals. I look forward positively to the prospect of pursuing my (course name) at your esteemed university.